Writing Exam 2 Review

Analyzing Evidence Slides

- What is the relationship between claims and facts?

- What is an unsubstantiated claim? Why are they problematic?
    - Be familiar with the following examples:

        - Prematurely jumping to conclusions
        - The "because I say so argument"
        - Circular reasoning

    - What's the easiest way to prevent unsubstantiated claims?

- What is a syllogism? What are the three parts?
    - What is a potential problem w/ syllogisms?

APA Structure and content (Ch. 2)

- Be familiar with APA formatting guidelines
    - Examples: Margins, font guidelines, heading levels, etc.

- Be familiar with the main body sections of an APA research article

- Be familiar with purpose statements. What makes a good purpose statement?

Grammar and Mechanics (Chs. 4-6)

- What is biased language? Why is it problematic?

- What is "person-centered" language? Why should we use it?

- What is meant by "appropriate level of detail" when describing a group of individuals?

- What is intersectionality? Why should we consider it?

- What is "fluffy" writing? Be familiar with the different ways to remove fluff from your writing!

- Why is concision important? How are concision and fluff related?

- Why is it important to write with a consistent style?

- What are the various elements of style? (Mechanics slides: slide 4)
- What are independent vs. dependent clauses?
- What is parallel structure in writing?
- Be familiar with the different levels of formality (informal, semiformal, and formal). What are the differences and what are some examples of each style?
- What is choppy writing? Be able to spot examples and fix it!
- Be able to identify redundancies in writing.
- What is jargon? Why is too much jargon a problem?
- What is the editorial “we”? Why should this be avoided?